LIVER DISEASE
THE HIDDEN DANGER

THE DEADLY NON-ALCOHOLIC FATTY LIVER DISEASE IS REACHING EPIDEMIC PROPORTIONS IN INDIA WITH 3 OUT OF 10 ADULTS AND CHILDREN AFFLICTED. WHAT YOU CAN DO TO PROTECT YOURSELF

By ***SONALI ACHARJEE***

It was a rib scan that 39-year-old Abhirup Bhalla, a banking executive in Gurugram, had gone for following a small car accident. But it threw up a surprise that had nothing to do with Bhalla's ribs. Rather, it revealed an enlarged liver. Enough for his doctor to recommend further tests and conclude that Bhalla had stage 1 fatty liver disease. The diagnosis left Bhalla shocked. He did not have a weight issue, thanks to his regular jogs at the Aravalli Biodiversity Park. "I don't drink or smoke either," he says. Non-alcoholic fatty liver disease (NAFLD) does come as a rude shock to lean people like Bhalla. He may not have been an alcoholic but Bhalla's diet was loaded with added sugar and junk food. So while the jogging kept his overall weight in check, the excess calories wreaked havoc on his liver.